BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MESRA
OFF-CAMPUS JAIPUR

Department of Animation & Multimedia

Department Activities and Achievements

I) BIT Jaipur Signs MoU with Drishti iHub, IIT Jodhpur for Collaboration in Animation and Digital Games

We are pleased to announce that the Department of Animation & Multimedia, BIT Jaipur has recently signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Drishti iHub, IIT Jodhpur, marking a significant step towards academic and industry collaboration in the field of Animation and Digital Games.

This partnership aims to foster innovation, skill development, and practical exposure for students. Under this MoU, there will be opportunities to jointly organize short-term courses, workshops, seminars, and other interactive academic activities, providing students with enriched learning experiences and industry-relevant knowledge.

This collaboration not only strengthens our academic network but also opens up new avenues for our students to engage with cutting-edge developments in digital media and gaming technologies.

II) International Academic Collaboration: Columbia University and BIT Join Hands on Environmental Animation Projects

The Department of Animation & Multimedia, BIT Jaipur will soon begin work on two animated short films addressing the issue of air pollution, in collaboration with Columbia University. A two-member team from Columbia University recently visited the department. During the visit, Professor Pam Litvik, Associate Dean of Research Resources at Columbia University, and Professor Pam Factor engaged with the faculty members of the Animation & Multimedia Department to discuss potential collaborative projects. Also present during the interaction were Dr. Piyush Tewari (Director), Professor Krishna Mohan, and Ms. Radhika Sharma, Director of Jeevan Ashram NGO.

III) Birla Institute of Technology Mesra, Jaipur Collaborates with Polish Foundation for Animation and Comics

BIT Mesra Jaipur Campus, India, has entered into an international collaboration with the Nil Desperandum Foundation, Poland, to develop an animation and comics-based project rooted in historical narratives.

The collaboration was formalized during a recent visit by Monika Kowalecz from the Polish foundation, who interacted with Dr. Vibhuti Pandya, Head of the Animation & Multimedia Department, along with faculty members and students.

The project focuses on creatively presenting archival materials and personal diaries from Poland's World War II history. It aims to engage younger audiences through digital platforms, including social media, as well as through potential comic book publications.

The Nil Desperandum Foundation brings with it a rich repository of archival resources, particularly stories related to the "Good Maharajas" and the Polish refugees who found shelter in India during World War II. Special emphasis will be given to the experiences of Polish children who were hosted and protected during that period.

This collaboration is expected to provide students with valuable international exposure while preserving and promoting significant historical narratives through the medium of animation and comics.

Key Project: Maharaja's Children

The collaboration produced a significant project titled "Maharaja's Children - A Brave Bunch in India," which tells the story of one thousand children saved from the hell of World War II. The project is based on true stories and has been recognized at various film festivals including Sundance Film Festival and Krakow Film Festival.

The project showcases archival materials and personal narratives from Poland's World War II history, particularly focusing on the experiences of Polish children who were hosted and protected by Indian "Maharajas" during World War II. This initiative represents a unique Indo-Polish cultural and historical collaboration.

Summary of International Collaborations

The Department of Animation & Multimedia at BIT Jaipur has established itself as a hub for international academic collaboration, with partnerships focusing on:

- Digital Media and Gaming Technologies - Through partnership with Drishti iHub, IIT Jodhpur
- Environmental Animation and Social Awareness - Through collaboration with Columbia University on air pollution awareness projects
- Historical Narratives and Cultural Preservation - Through partnership with Nil Desperandum Foundation, Poland, focusing on World War II stories and Polish-Indian heritage

These collaborations provide students with valuable international exposure, hands-on experience on real-world projects, and opportunities to engage with cutting-edge developments in animation, comics, and digital media.

[Note: The original PDFs contain photographs from collaboration meetings, film posters of "Maharaja's Children" project, and event documentation showing faculty members, international collaborators, and students participating in these initiatives]